

found better paying jobs. For some reason, the situation at home never improved.

When Willy decided to go to college, he was sure that he would qualify for financial aid grants since his family was so poor. To his great surprise, he was turned down because his parents made too much money. Confronting his parents, they explained that they saved their money for a rainy day. Willy responded, "The rainy day has arrived."

His parents were so terrified to part with their money that they refused Willy's request for college assistance. Their great fear of losing their money and deep need for security at all costs ended up costing them their son. Willy ended up borrowing the money for college and has not spoken to his parents in years.

Willy's parents had lost sight of the reason behind saving and were obsessed only with the act of saving itself. By being scared to withdraw any money, they kept their family in unnecessary poverty. They could have easily withdrawn money for important necessities like a reliable car, a college education, and improved living conditions without reducing their savings to an inadequate level. In fact, with their savings they could have sent both of their children to Harvard and still have had a very substantial amount in their retirement account.

Their fear of running out of money and ending up in poverty turned out to be a self-fulfilling prophecy because they lived a poverty-like existence. By confronting this fear, their family could have lived a life without so many deprivations. Their son Willy might still be talking to them, and their hard earned money could have proudly been responsible for part or all of his college education.

If only they had developed a plan to reach their family's goals (which is detailed in the next chapter) they could have been comforted by the knowledge that they had enough money to send their children to college. Unfortunately, Willy's

